

Object Oriented Programming

Object Oriented Programming (OOP) is a programming concept, involving objects and their interactions to design applications and various computer programs. The highlights included within this programming technique are encapsulation, modularity, polymorphism, and inheritance. This concept was not conventionally used in mainstream software development and predominantly came into practice in the early '90s. These days, most programming languages support OOP. The main reason for this is the need to remove the flaws encountered in the typical procedural approach used in archaic programming through the computing ages.

OOP originates way back to the sixties. Over the years, as the hardware and software evolved, quality was often compromised. Analysts and designers were soon looking for ways to address this problem. OOP focuses on data instead of processes, with programs composed of self-sufficient modules (objects) that contain all the information needed for manipulation.

'Simula' was the first language to introduce OOP to the programming world. The various terminologies it brought were objects, classes, subclasses, virtual methods, co-routines, garbage collection, and discrete event simulation. The language was also used for physical modelling. However, the first language which was labelled as an 'Object Oriented' language was 'Small Talk'.

The highlights of OOP are:

- Emphasis on data rather than the procedure.
- Programs are divided into entities known as objects.